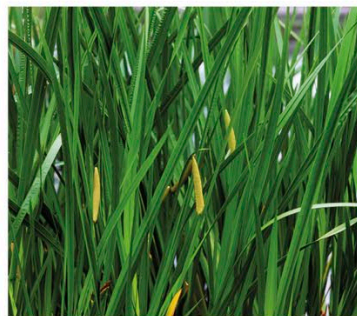




Plants for ponds

The list of plants for shady pools is considerably shorter than the list for ponds in sun. Most water plants need some light to put on the best show.

Unless you have a natural pond in deep shade, choose the brightest site available for a water feature, or your options will be limited to the spring-flowering skunk cabbage, which, although beautiful, acquired its common name for a good reason. However, in partly shaded ponds, your choice of iris, marsh marigold, calla lily, and other marginals will create a dynamic display of colorful reflections from spring until fall. The few evergreens for ponds include water figwort and horsetail; keep the latter's roots confined to a pond basket.



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Acorus calamus

SWEET FLAG This upright perennial can be either deciduous or semievergreen. It is grown largely for its clumps of grasslike green leaves. In summer, it produces insignificant brown flowers. It is tolerant of light shade.

↑↔24in (60cm)

Z4–10 (N)



PERENNIAL SMALL

Calla palustris

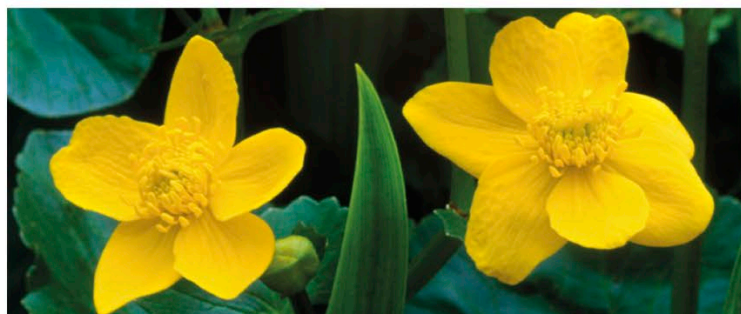
BOG ARUM A spreading deciduous or semievergreen marginal perennial with heart-shaped glossy leaves and large, vase-shaped white bracts, each surrounding a fleshy spike of minute flowers followed by red or orange berries.

↑10in (25cm) ↔12in (30cm)

① Z4–8 (N)



PERENNIAL SMALL



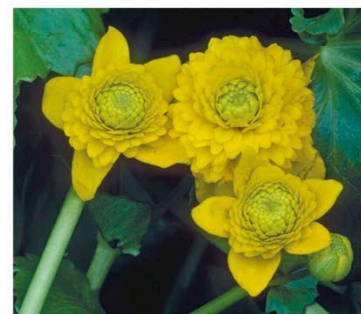
PERENNIAL SMALL

Caltha palustris

MARSH MARIGOLD This perennial marginal produces rounded, heart-shaped green leaves and golden-yellow single or double flowers on lax stems in early spring. It tolerates light shade with some sun during the day. It will self-seed and spread.

↑16in (40cm) ↔18in (45cm)

Z3–7 (N)



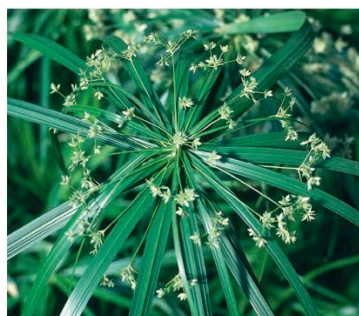
PERENNIAL SMALL

Caltha palustris 'Flore Pleno'

syn. *Caltha palustris* 'Multiplex' This small perennial bears the same dark green leaves as the species. Clusters of bright golden double flowers appear in spring. It is also suitable for pond perimeters.

↑↔10in (25cm)

Z3–7 (N)



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Cyperus involucratus

UMBRELLA PLANT An evergreen perennial marginal sedge treated as an annual. Its tall, upright slender stems end in a whorl of horizontal grassy bracts. Airy sprays of tiny yellowish green flowers arise from the "umbrellas" in summer. Protect from frost.

↑3ft (1m) ↔12in (30cm)

Z9–11



PERENNIAL SMALL

Houttuynia cordata

HOUTTUYNIA This vigorous spreading perennial has heart-shaped, orange-scented blue-green leaves. Yellow-centered white blooms form in late spring. Restrict its roots in a pond basket. 'Chameleon' (above) has yellow- and red-splashed foliage.

↑12in (30cm) ↔indefinite

Z5–10



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Iris ensata

JAPANESE WATER IRIS This upright perennial has sword-shaped gray-green leaves. From early- to midsummer, it produces flowers in shades of purple, pink, and white, depending on the variety. Plant it in shallow water.

↑3ft (1m) ↔24in (60cm)

① Z4–9

Gardamine pratensis

LADY'S SMOCK This small perennial marginal or bog plant produces divided leaves. It bears clusters of pinkish mauve flowers in late spring. Grow this plant in very shallow water or a bog garden in shade.

↑18in (45cm) ↔12in (30cm)

Z4–8 (N)